

HFD 108 FASHION FIGURE DRAWING

ASSIGNMENT GUIDELINE 6 (WEEK 9)

Rendering Textures (Black & White)

Rendering textures in black and white is an important skill in fashion illustration because it helps designers communicate the look, feel, and weight of fabric without relying on color. Through careful use of line, shading, and contrast, a designer can show whether a garment is soft, rough, shiny, thick, flowing, or structured. Black and white rendering trains the eye to focus on texture, form, and lighting, which are essential in presenting garment ideas clearly and professionally. Designers use techniques such as **hatching**, **cross-hatching**, **stippling**, **blending**, and **smudging** to build depth and realism in sketches.

Light and Shadow

Light and shadow are used in fashion illustration to create the illusion of three-dimensional form and depth. When light falls on a garment, some areas become highlighted while others appear darker depending on the folds, curves, and direction of the fabric. Highlights are the brightest areas where light directly touches the surface, while shadows appear in recessed or folded areas. Correct placement of shadows helps the figure and garment appear realistic and gives volume to clothing.

Shading techniques are important when rendering light and shadow. Smooth shading is commonly used for soft fabrics and skin because it creates gradual tonal transitions. Cross-hatching and layered pencil strokes can create darker tones and add texture to garments. Fashion designers should observe where light naturally falls on the body, such as under folds, beneath sleeves, around pleats, and near seams. Understanding tonal values from light gray to deep black helps create balance, realism, and visual interest in fashion sketches.

Materiality in Fabric Rendering

Materiality refers to the visual representation of how different fabrics behave and feel. In black and white rendering, designers use different strokes and shading styles to distinguish between stiff, structured fabrics and soft, flowing materials. The way pencil marks are applied communicates the physical characteristics of the textile.

Stiff fabrics such as denim, canvas, or leather are illustrated using firm, sharp, and controlled lines. These materials usually have stronger folds, angular creases, and less fluid movement. Darker shadows and heavier outlines help emphasize thickness and weight. Denim, for example, often shows visible seam details, rough texture, and structured folds around joints like knees and elbows.

Soft fabrics such as silk, chiffon, satin, or jersey require smoother and lighter shading techniques. These materials drape naturally around the body and form flowing folds with soft edges. Designers often use blended tones, curved strokes, and delicate highlights to show softness and shine. Silk and satin may include bright highlights and smooth tonal transitions to suggest their reflective

surfaces. Chiffon is usually rendered with light lines and transparent layering to create an airy appearance.

A skilled fashion illustrator studies fabric behavior carefully because each textile reacts differently to movement, gravity, and light. Practicing texture rendering improves the designer's ability to communicate garment construction, fabric quality, and overall mood in fashion presentations.

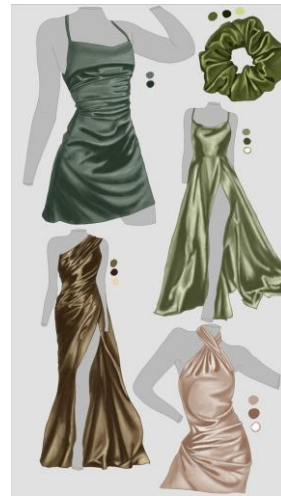
Importance of Black and White Texture Rendering in Fashion Design

Black and white rendering develops observation skills and strengthens a designer's understanding of fabric structure before introducing color. It allows designers to focus on shape, contrast, and texture without distraction. This technique is widely used in fashion portfolios, technical illustrations, concept sketches, and design development because it clearly communicates ideas to clients, pattern makers, and manufacturers. Strong rendering skills also improve creativity and help designers present garments in a more professional and realistic way. Below is a visual assortment of sample texture renderings

DENIM



SILK



LEATHER



ASSIGNMENT 1

Create three different bold illustrations featuring models wearing garments made from the following materials: **silk**, **leather**, and **denim**, with one illustration on each page. Rely on researched personal references from online sources. Explore media such as marker pens, graphite, and colored pencils.